

PS3 Slim announced

Sony finally announced the PS3 Slim, going on sale on September 1st

First Lynnfield CPU out

Although not officially launched, the 2.66 GHz Core i5 750 has already made it's way into a few hands

Cowon D2+

She shook me all night long

At first look it doesn't impress with a credit card sized body that's 0.65-inches thick and minimalistic frills but everything about the build bespeaks quality from the finish to the slightly recessed, 2.5-inch touchscreen that is crisp with good colour although the on-screen icons could do with a makeover. Support for multiple audio formats including .FLAC and .APE and a load of video formats, SD expansion along with a proprietary AV out and a bundled notepad and flash player tells of a serious feature set. The touchscreen works well although at times a mishit occurred; the menu is well laid out but appears dull; could be better.

In terms of sound quality the D2+ scores big and is easily a cut above most run-of-the-mill PMPs. Music is involving – bass is crisp with a nice hit,

but not as deep as some may like. The min-range is a lot of fun and very involving; there is a lot of emotion and weight to female voices in particular and guitar tracks are very involving. Our only complaint though one hardly noticeable by non-discerning users is the lack of control in the top-end and at times the D2+ drove our reference cans to sibilance and extra sparkle in the treble that loses detail. In really complex passages the instruments do get a little congested.

Video playback is good, with crisp output, but really for a video PMP a bigger screen is mandatory and anything with a resolution of above 320 x 240 pixels will not play. The bundled earphones are pretty decent. Battery life is excellent with well over a day of MP3 playback. At Rs. 9,500 for the 8 GB version the D2+ is a high-end PMP but one that does a



bit of everything and quite well. Purist audiophiles will find something to nitpick, but it's good value. Don't buy it for it's video component.

RATINGS

Features.....	8
Build Quality.....	8
Performance.....	8
Value.....	7.5
Overall	8

Contact

Lipap Systems Private Ltd

Email: iaudio@lipap.com

Web site: www.cowonindia.in

Phone: +91-98199 17440

Price: Rs. 9,500

Specifications

Screen: 2.5-inch touch, 16M colours; **Audio:** built-in voice recorder, FM radio, 74 mW output power, multiple audio and video formats supported; **Weight:** 91 grams

Gigabyte GM-M6880

Large 'n light

Contact

Priya Ltd.

Phone: +91-22-42203100

Email: sales@priyagroup.com

Web site: www.gigabyte.in

Price: Rs. 945

Specifications

Resolution: 800 / 1600 dpi switchable

Cable length: 1.5m

Dimensions: (L)127 x (W)75 x (H)42 mm

Weight: 145 g

RATINGS

Features	6
Performance	6
Build quality	6
Value for money.....	7
Overall	6

Gigabyte is normally known for their computer hardware such as motherboards and graphic cards. But this time around we are checking out the GM-M6880 which is a gaming mouse from Gigabyte.

The GM-M6880 has a glossy black exterior with a total of six buttons on it; the regular three buttons, a single dpi button and two customizable buttons on the left side which can be reached by the thumb. The overall ergonomic design of this mouse is well suited for those with larger hands. You can adjust the dpi settings on this mouse with a click of a button, but only between 800 and 1600.

Moving the GM-M6880

was really not a problem and the pads provided were very smooth. But the drawback we see here is the weight of this mouse (145 grams including the wire), as it just felt that the mouse was moving faster than normal. Also when you click hard, which will be a scenario with intense moments while gaming, the mouse seems to move off balance and slightly tilt forward, which is something gamers do not want.

The glossy plastic material used is not the best either, as when and if you start to sweat, the precision of clicking will reduce and you will tend to slip.

Overall, this mouse does have the gaming appeal to it with its design, and is priced



very competitively at Rs. 945, as far as gaming peripherals are concerned. The Gigabyte GM-M6880 will attract those of you who are just starting gaming and don't want to spend a lot of money on their peripherals, yet. If you are a veteran or pro gamer, then this is not something that you would enjoy.